

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Offline maps & route planning

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QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Save maps before service fails, write down your destination and at least one alternative, and check the actual route against current hazards. An offline map does not show live closures, fighting, damaged bridges or flooding. GPS position may still work without data, but accuracy and battery life are not guaranteed.

Do now.

- ☐ **Download before the outage**
01 Use the map app's offline feature for the whole journey, not just the destination. Test it with mobile data off.
- ☐ **Keep a paper backup**
02 Write addresses, landmarks, route choices and emergency contacts. Carry a paper map if available.
- ☐ **Check route suitability**
03 Consider flood zones, damaged structures, access needs and transport restrictions. The fastest app route is not necessarily the safest.
- ☐ **Conserve device power**
04 Reduce unnecessary screen use and keep a power bank available. Know how to view the downloaded map without needing a new connection.
- ☐ **Reassess as conditions change**
05 Stop in a safe place to compare the route with visible conditions and recent trusted reports. Do not enter an uncertain road simply because the map displays it.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use known routes and written landmarks while checking conditions from safe positions. If you cannot identify a safe onward route, reassess rather than consuming the last battery on repeated rerouting.

Watch for.

Maps and position tools are aids, not proof of safe passage. Avoid unfamiliar shortcuts through hazardous or recently fought-over ground.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: download before the outage. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Maps and position tools are aids, not proof of safe passage. Avoid unfamiliar shortcuts through hazardous or recently fought-over ground.

Keep essentials within reach.

For offline maps & route planning, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Use known routes and written landmarks while checking conditions from safe positions. If you cannot identify a safe onward route, reassess rather than consuming the last battery on repeated rerouting. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Practise following a short route with the backup information. Include a destination you can reach on foot only if that is realistic for the household and conditions.

First decision: Download before the outage

Use the map app's offline feature for the whole journey, not just the destination. Test it with mobile data off. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Use known routes and written landmarks while checking conditions from safe positions. If you cannot identify a safe onward route, reassess rather than consuming the last battery on repeated rerouting. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Maps and position tools are aids, not proof of safe passage. Avoid unfamiliar shortcuts through hazardous or recently fought-over ground. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

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What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For offline maps & route planning, keep the specific hazard in view: Maps and position tools are aids, not proof of safe passage. Avoid unfamiliar shortcuts through hazardous or recently fought-over ground.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Reassess as conditions change. Stop in a safe place to compare the route with visible conditions and recent trusted reports. Do not enter an uncertain road simply because the map displays it. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

National Park Service · Hiking safety

<https://www.nps.gov/articles/hiking-safety.htm>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/offline-maps/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.